Beyond Localhost: .NET Agents in Foundry

From dotnet run to a Foundry hosted agent



Bruno Capuano

Principal Cloud Advocate, Microsoft

"

“OK, the agent is done… now, how do I deploy this thing?”

A developer friend

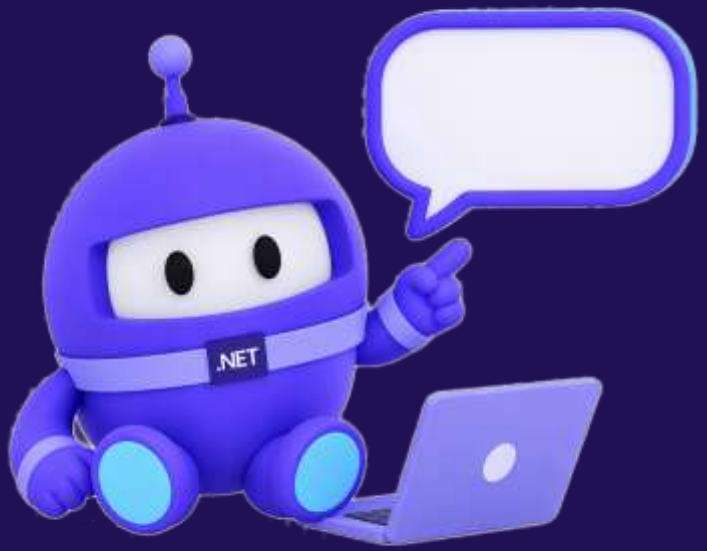
The starting question



> “Before hosting anything, what is the smallest agent that works?”

The first question

Start small



Demo 01: the agent on its own

LIVE DEMO

01 02 03 04 05

One agent, one request, one answer



Watch for: the instructions, the agent name and a single run

“Before it leaves my laptop, can the agent answer requests like a service?”

The next question

Ready to host



Demo 02: the same agent, ready to host

LIVE DEMO

01 **02** 03 04 05

The agent answers like a service, still on my laptop



Watch for: the hosting registrations and a local call

03 The agent in Foundry



Foundry Hosted Agents

Managed hosting

Platform



Foundry runs it

- Scales to zero
- Persistent session state
- Own Entra agent identity
- OpenAI-compatible endpoint

Protocol



You pick the protocol

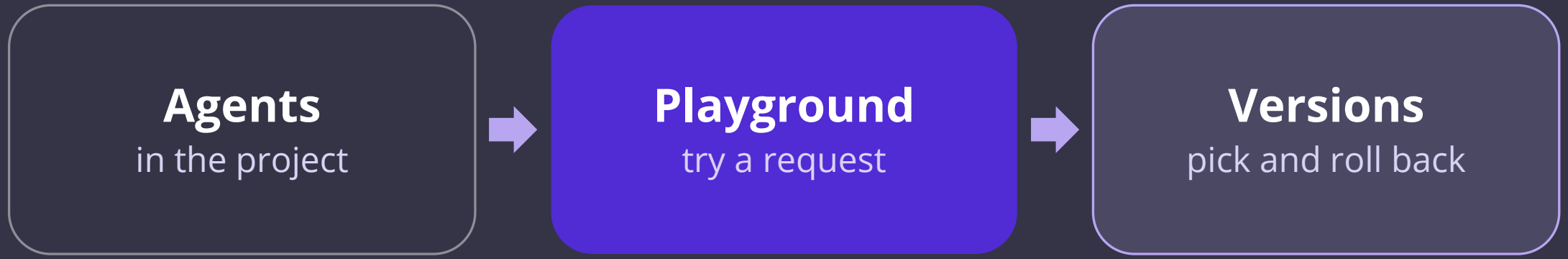
- Responses: managed history
- Invocations: raw HTTP control
- An agent can expose both
- Unsure? Start with Responses

Demo 03a: the Foundry portal

LIVE DEMO

01 02 **03** 04 05

Where hosted agents live before we ship any code



Watch for: the Playground and the version list

Demo 03b: same agent, in Foundry

LIVE DEMO

01 02 **03** 04 05

Same code, now running in Foundry



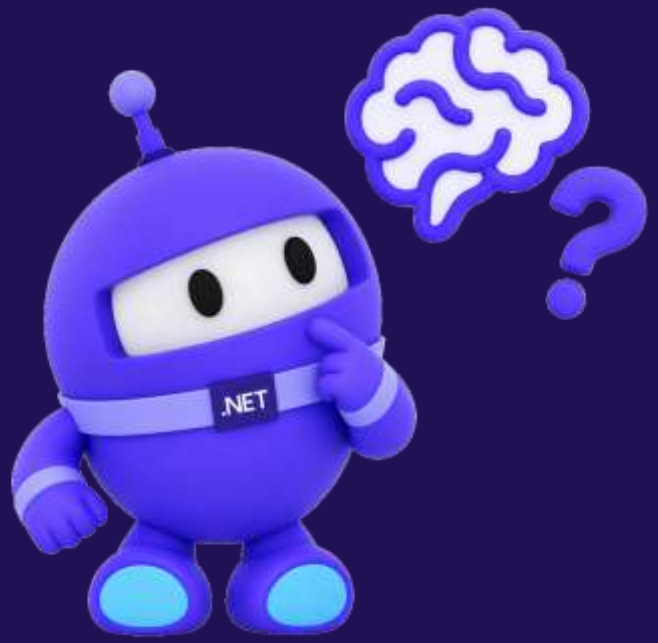
Watch for: a new agent version answering from the Playground

“Does an agent need an LLM to work?”

A frequent question

The open question

Answer in the chat



"

“Route each support ticket to the right team, and let a person confirm”

A bounded problem

The problem

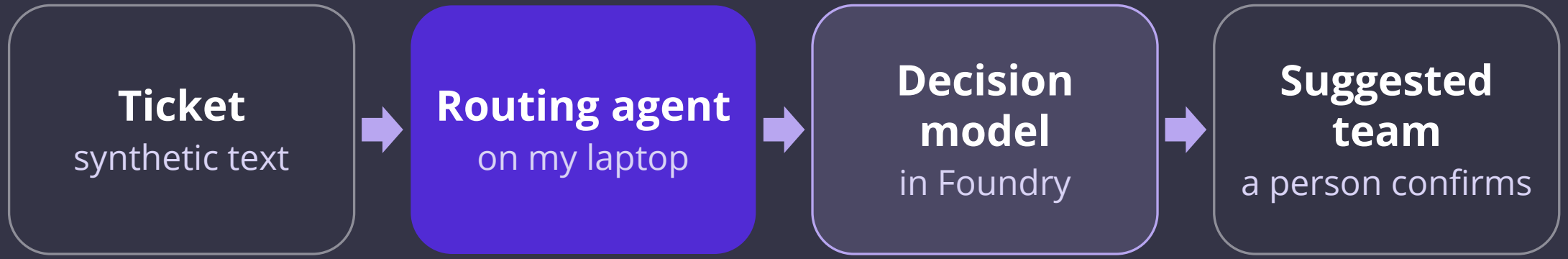


Demo 04: deciding without chat

LIVE DEMO

01 02 03 **04** 05

Route a support ticket with a decision model, no chat



Watch for: the selected team, its confidence and the human check

Decision-1 is built on Qwen3.5-9B; no chat call generates the rationale

“What changes when my laptop is no longer in the loop?”

The identity question

Leave the laptop

Answer in the chat

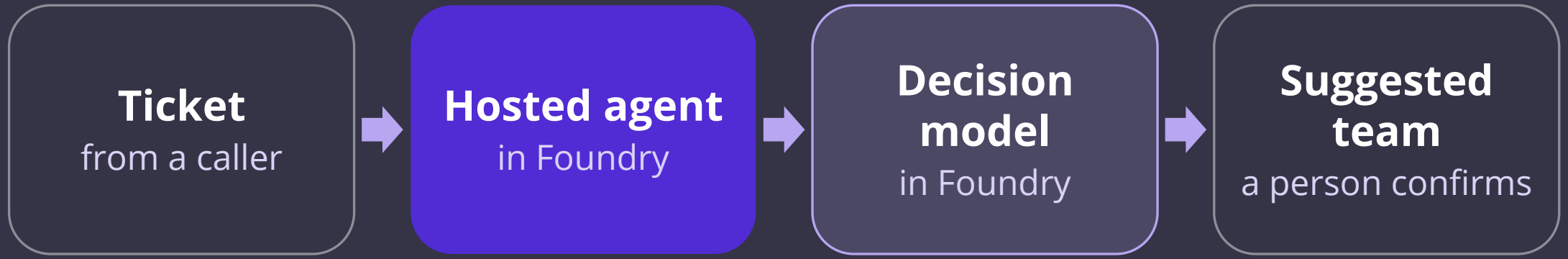


Demo 05: same decision, in Foundry

LIVE DEMO

01 02 03 04 **05**

The same decision, with my laptop out of the loop



Watch for: the same route, using the agent's own identity

Locally: AzureCliCredential → Hosted: ManagedIdentityCredential, the agent's own identity

Key takeaways

What to remember

- Same agent, new home: hosting changes where it runs, not the code
- Hosting is a protocol plus an identity
- An agent needs its own logic, which may or may not use an LLM

Learn more

Docs and samples

- **Blog: From dotnet run to Foundry Hosted Agent**
  devblogs.microsoft.com/dotnet/from-dotnet-run-to-foundry-hosted-agent-in-3-lines-of-csharp
- **Docs: Hosted agents with Agent Framework**
  learn.microsoft.com/agent-framework/hosting/foundry-hosted-agent?pivots=programming-language-csharp
- **Docs: Hosted agent identity and tokens**
  learn.microsoft.com/azure/foundry/agents/concepts/hosted-agent-token-service
- **Sample: DecisionAgent-01-FoundryHosted**
  github.com/microsoft/Generative-AI-for-beginners-dotnet



Scan for the sample

Thank you

